



BACKGROUND:

Burnaby is home to people from many cultures and backgrounds. The City of Burnaby wants to make sure everyone can enjoy public recreation — like swimming pools, parks, and community centres. But there has not been much research on how immigrant and racialized families experience these spaces in British Columbia. This project helps fill that gap.

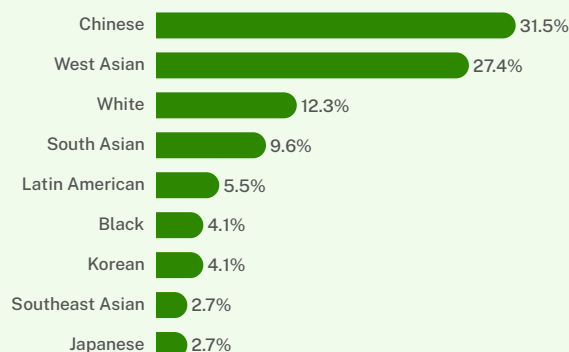
We talked to immigrant and newcomer families in Burnaby about public recreation such as parks, recreation programs, community centers like swimming pools. Many people shared their experiences through surveys, interviews, and small group conversations. This handout shares what we have heard so far.



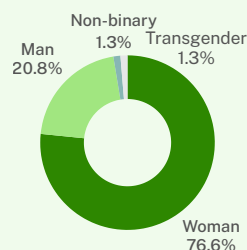
Who did we hear from?

We heard from 196 people in total through our survey. This data is from the 78 respondents who have lived in BC for 6 years or less.

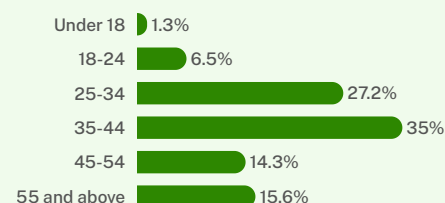
ETHNIC BACKGROUND



GENDER



AGE



TIME LIVING IN B.C



How do newcomers feel about recreation?

BELONGING



5 out of 6

feel welcome in places like parks and community centres.



5 out of 6

see people like themselves in recreation activities.

BELONGING + DIGNITY



4 out of 6

feel like they fit in when joining recreation activities.



5 out of 6

feel comfortable sharing their ideas about recreation activities.

DIGNITY + JUSTICE



4 out of 6

feel that there are enough recreation activities in the community.



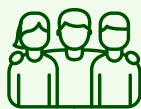
4 out of 6

feel that the recreation activities in the community are right for them.



How people find out about recreation activities?

47.4%



Friends or family

47.4%



Social media

34.0%



Recreation Centres or City Website



Why do newcomers participate?

65.38%



To enjoy nature

58.9%



To have fun

56.4%



To spend time with family & friends



Which activities did people participate in the most?

67.9%



Parks and playgrounds

50%



Swimming and pool activities

39.7%



Community events or festivals



What stops people from joining recreation?

24.4%



Lack of awareness

21.8%



Lack of information

20.5%



Language barrier



Swimming in Burnaby

CAN SWIM



5 out of 6

FEEL COMFORTABLE SWIMMING



3 out of 6

WHAT STOPS PEOPLE FROM GOING SWIMMING?

24.4%



Worried about safety

16.7%



Don't know how to swim

7.7%



Swimwear or clothing rules

"they need somebody in between to make this connecting point because of their language barrier"

"So, I'm a newcomer, I have been living in Vancouver not very long. So actually, I haven't actually been to a community center to use any recreation"

"I don't know where to look for what"

"you want to do like an exercise like dance and zumba classes, but you see that there is only children care (to drop them off) from 9 to 12, but that's it... When you want to go, it's already over and it is an hour max."

"when I started being a mom, I didn't know that all of this existed"

"it's very interesting for me to learn that such services or centers are available because we don't have such a thing in our country."



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